

Company: NOMURA

Job Profile: GM (Global Markets)

Offer Type: Internship + Placement

Internship Stipend: 75,000 INR

CTC: 13.66 LPA (11.66L Base + 2L Joining)

Location: Powai

Process Date: 31st July OA, 1st August 2025 Interview Day 1, 4th August Interview Day 2

The interview experience is slightly longer than usual, but I've tried to cover any questions anyone can have. I hope this 5 minute read can really help you out in your preparation.

Placement Process:

The company came with 3 roles - GM, ITD and CDO. We were required to fill in 2 of our preferences. The ITD role had an aptitude test and shortlisting for GM and CDO roles were done on the basis of our resumes. I had applied for ITD and GM.

1. Pre-placement Talk - 28th July
2. Aptitude Test (for ITD, not GM, but the year prior, there was an aptitude test for GM as well) - 31st July
3. Group Discussion Round - 1st August (up to the HR round)
4. Technical Round-1
5. Technical Round-2
6. HR Round

Now the further rounds were conducted for just me and another student after we cleared HR (no clear reason was given as to why)

7. Virtual Techno HR Round 1 - 4th August
8. Virtual Techno HR Round 2 - 4th August

I'll cover details of the OA (Aptitude Test) very briefly. Around **180+ students** applied for the OA. It was a **60 minute** exam with 20 questions on **Analytical, Verbal and Quantitative** Sections each (thus total **60 questions**), conducted on MeritTrac's Platform - Pariksha. The questions were easy to medium. What mattered most was **speed**. I was able to complete around 55 questions by the end, and tried smart guesses for the rest, as there were no negative marking. So solve the easier questions first, as you can switch between questions and sections.

The OA results came at around 7 in the evening. Shortly after the shortlists for GM and CDO also came out. I was shortlisted for ITD and GM roles. Generally all shortlists come a day prior to the interviews. So if one is selected for interviews, for that day they should go through their Resume very well first and foremost. **BE VERY THOROUGH ON WHAT YOU ADD ON YOUR RESUMES**, otherwise it's better to skip that skill. Then quickly try revising basic concepts, DSA notes if you have any, and skim through the interview experiences of that particular company, as it gives you a fair idea of the process. These are the things that I did.

The below part is only going to be focused for the GM role. For ITD, there are other interview experiences in the drive which you can check out.

GM Role JD -  GM SPIT Tech focused Intern role_JD - 2025.pdf

Some people have misconceptions that the role is Non Tech, but it's not the case. It's a **Tech Role** which you can see in the JD.

1. Group Discussion [19 students appeared for this round]

The 19 students were split into two panels. There were around 9 students in my panel. The topic was given to us directly during the GD (no prior indication), and no phones allowed, pure brainstorming. The topic was relatively easy to prepare on - 'Is AI making us Smarter or Dependent'. I had gathered my panel members prior to the round and advised them that we should do the GD collaboratively, allowing everyone to keep their points, and avoid opposing and conflicts as much as possible, which would give everyone a fair chance. This worked, and the GD went very smooth, and lasted for around 30 minutes. I made around 3-4 valid points. Make sure to actively participate in the discussion, but not dominate it as well. The key is to be confident, be active and try to maintain fluency. The motive of the GD is just to see how well and actively a student participates, contributes and presents their ideas in a discussion. Take a pen and paper to jot down points. Examples of GDs on youtube, are more than enough to prepare.

2. Technical Round-1 [10 students appeared for this round]

The round began with the interviewer asking me to introduce myself.. I introduced myself, told him about my internship and my contribution to it. Then I talked about my projects, giving him some overview about them, to which he would ask some questions in between regarding them. Then he began asking some basic questions, such as defining data structures like HashMap, Stack, Queue, LinkedList, etc. This was pretty easy, so I even explained some extra info for each, such as what is collision in hashmap, struct of LinkedList, etc and gave examples for each. Then he proceeded to ask two easy level DSA questions:

- 1) Implement Queue using Stack - Simple implementation using 2 stacks
- 2) Remove duplicates from an array (order should be maintained) - Using a HashMap to maintain order and remove duplicates.

I solved both of them very quickly, and the interviewer only needed the logic, no code or pseudocode.

Then he asked me briefly about my experience with Flask, React, etc (they were mentioned in the JD), but didn't ask any questions about them. He then asked me if I knew Python, to which I replied that it was my primary language. Then he proceeded with asking multiple questions on Python. Some of them were:

- 1) Simple questions like the difference between List and Tuple. Which of them can be used as a key in a dictionary, which cannot, and why not.
- 2) What is List Comprehension and what's the syntax
- 3) How dictionaries work in Python, how to sort them by keys and by values.

- 4) OOPs questions in python and how is it implemented in Python, what are abstract methods, and access modifiers in python.
- 5) What are Decorator Functions in Python (he asked me to write a decorator function)
- 6) What is args and kwargs
- 7) Write a function to convert a Flattened Dictionary into an Unflattened Dictionary.

E.g) Flattened Dictionary : table= {'a.b.c':1, 'd.e':2, 'f':3} as input should give

Output: table={a: {b: {c:1}}, d: {e:2}, f:3}

I wrote a recursive function explaining each step while writing the function, and was able to solve it in some time. He wanted to check how efficiently I write codes in python.

I was able to answer all questions except the syntax of the decorator wrapper function. I asked him a question about the role and his experience at the end.

The interview lasted for around 35 minutes.

3. **Technical Round-2** [6 students appeared for this round]

The interviewer looked through my resume and asked me a question on what Apache Kafka is and how it works (it was mentioned on my resume). I explained all the concepts related to Kafka, how they work, gave examples of their use-case and real life scenarios, and how I implemented it into my project.

Then he gave me two tables, and asked me to first tell him what I can infer from it, and then write the SQL query for it.

The question was as follows:

Given a table, lets say Table, for every Note, print the entire row with the max Tranche

Transactions	Note	Pipeline	Tranche
T1	N1	P2	2
T2	N1	P1	1
T4	N2	P1	2
T1	N2	P1	1
T2	N3	P2	1

Output:

Transactions	Note	Pipeline	Max_Tranche
T1	N1	P2	2
T4	N2	P1	2
T2	N3	P2	1

I had messed up a bit initially, to which the interviewer gave me a hint, after which I was able to solve the query. The query included Sub Query, Aggregation, Grouping and Join concepts. It was as follows:-

```
SELECT t2.Transactions, t2.Note, t2.Pipeline, t2.Max_Tranche
FROM ( SELECT MAX(Tranche), Note AS Max_Tranche FROM Table GROUP BY Note) AS t1
JOIN Table AS t2
ON t1.Note=t2.Note
```

After this he began asking me questions on core DBMS. Some of the questions were:

- 1) What is RDBMS? Why is it used?
- 2) What is Normalisation and what is its purpose? What are the pros and cons of an overly normalized table and a completely unnormalised table
- 3) What is Indexing, how does it work? Why is it beneficial? Which data structure is used for it, and how does it work? When is it a good option and when is it not?
- 4) What is Partitioning and Sharding. What's the difference?
- 5) What is Data Replication? Why is it important?
- 6) What is a Composite Key? How is it different from the Primary Key
- 7) What is a Foreign Key and what happens when you delete a row with a primary key as the foreign key to another table. How do you resolve the error?

There were a few more basic questions, I don't remember clearly.

I was able to answer all the questions asked to me, and I tried to always give some extra info related to the solution. The interviewer seemed content with all my answers. After this he was about to ask me a DSA question, but asked to just explain Collision in hashmaps, that's it.

At the end I asked him how the transition from college to corporate is, and what was his experience.

The interview lasted for around 25-30 minutes.

4. **HR Round** [4 students appeared for this round]

The interview began with the interviewer asking me a brief intro about myself, what I've done and what are my skills, and my experience as the Head of Marketing at Oculus. He then asked me about my understanding of the JD. I replied according to what I had researched about it. Then he asked me for the top 3 qualities about myself, and a little about my internship. He then asked me what drives me to do more. Looking at my CGPA, he asked me if I was in the top 30% of my class, and why I was not higher. Then he asked me a tricky question, which was "When should one do MBA" (he wanted to check if i had any plans for it). I turned it around by stating that the correct question should be "Why MBA", and started building around it. He proceeded to ask me questions about my family background and where I live. He also mentioned that my travel from Colaba to Powai won't be so joyous, to which I said I'm accustomed to it, and might consider shifting. He asked me to rate myself in coding, what would be my actions if someone is better at it, at work, and what ratio would I draw between tech and finance market during my work. Lastly, I made comments on how I'm a good fit for the role, as the role serves both verticals of Tech and Finance, and I have the appropriate technical, communication skills and the business acumen required.

So the key to clearing HR is being honest, confident and not lying. You do need to build stories around your answer, give examples from your experiences and never give single statement answers. Apart from that they want to see how you present yourself, your expressions, and how you handle pressure. They don't want robots who just know how to work.

Note - After this round, only one student was immediately selected, and me and another candidate were scheduled for more Virtual Interviews on 4th August (1st was a Friday, and offices are closed on weekends, hence Monday). However we did figure out that we were being considered for different roles, as

the other candidate had a completely Non Technical and Financial Background, and his process was different as well.

No clear reason was given as to why this was being done. But I need to admit, I was a bit confused and slightly disappointed. The next 2 days were very stressful, somewhat torturous, as no information was given regarding what will be the next rounds, how they will go about and why they were scheduled.

But it's very important to keep your composure, not lose hope. I kept talking to two of my friends who really supported me during the process, to keep my mind off these things. I didn't exactly prepare anything extra in those 2 days, as I believe there's no point to it, and it's just gonna add more pressure. I did prepare for some common HR questions though.

On Sunday night, the TPC instructed me to keep my phone on the entire time the next day, as even they didn't know when the interviews would be scheduled. So I was ready in formals and my laptop from 8 in the morning. Later I was informed that my interview is at 2:30 pm.

5. **Virtual Techno HR Round-1**

It began with the interviewer asking me to introduce myself and talk a bit about my internship and projects, and how I did them. She then said she'll be asking me questions on Python, to which I thought it would be like the last round, but it wasn't the case. She began by asking me what's the difference between loc and iloc. I thought she meant about the 'Lock' in threading in python, to which i explained everything. She then told me she means loc and iloc in Pandas. I was taken aback at that time as i had never done pandas specifically, which i told her as well. Regardless, she went to ask me questions on Pandas, like:

- 1) loc and iloc
- 2) How to drop null values
- 3) How to fill in rows with null values
- 4) How to merge two dataframes
- 5) What's the difference between Left merge and Right merge

I explained approaches for all of them, but did not know the syntax for them, which I honestly told the interviewer.

She then asked me some behavioral questions. She asked me how I would proceed if I had worked on something, which was later discarded because the manager feels there's a more optimal approach. I replied honestly that I would try to understand the situation and adapt to the better solution, as we always go through that in DSA. Then she asked me what I do if I'm stuck somewhere and not able to solve a certain problem or write some code. I explained that I tend to read documentations first, then try sites like StackOverflow, maybe ask my peers or seniors, and then lastly try some AI tools like ChatGPT or Claude. She asked me in what ratio, which approach I would use. Then she asked me what I would do if a member in my team is slacking in terms of work or not performing. I gave an appropriate answer, saying I would discuss with that member first, try to understand the problem, if it still doesn't solve it, i'd probably escalate to the manager. I gave example scenarios or past experiences for each answer as well.

At the end, I made a statement that although the interview started on the wrong note, as I wasn't able to give the syntax for Pandas, I'm a quick learner and can adapt well to new technologies, instances of which I have proved earlier. To this she said it's alright.

The interview lasted for around 45 minutes.

In all honesty I had almost given up hopes as I was not able to give good responses to the technical questions. Also the other candidate had given a good interview, and another round was already scheduled for him at 6:30 (not for me till then). Just as I gave up, I received a call from the TPC that we both have been called to the office the next day at Powai. However, I had been shortlisted for the OA of another company for the next day, so he asked me to make a decision, to which I said I want to proceed with Nomura (obviously). Later the people at Nomura themselves said that they don't want me to miss my OA for another company, and that they're ready to immediately take the next round at 7:30 PM. So I rushed back to my laptop in formals.

6. Virtual Techno HR Round-2

The interviewer (she was taking the interview from her home as well, as it was too late) began by asking me to give an introduction about myself, my projects, my experiences and so on. Then asked me to explain in detail about one of my mentioned projects, and what state it is in now. I gave a complete explanation of the architecture, high level design, working, flow, use of the project, and how it was used in a real competition. She then asked me what challenges I faced during that project, and how I solved them. She asked if I had ever worked with something that was new to me in a short period of time. She then asked me about my internship experience and what was my most important learning there. She also asked me what I did as the Head of Marketing at Oculus.

She then asked a few python questions. She told me that there's a lot of electronic data coming in continuously, and we only have limited memory resources. So how would I process the data? I told her that I would use Pagination to split the incoming data into chunks, then use multithreading to parallelly process the data, with each thread responsible for some chunk of data, and finally use the garbage collector to discard threads not in use. She was satisfied with the answer. She then asked me what are lambda functions and asked me multiple implementations of it. The other questions were very easy.

Then she asked me about my hobbies and if I had any questions. By the end the interview almost became a bit casual, we were almost just conversing at that point. The interview lasted for around 35 minutes.

Later I was told the results will be announced the next morning. At that point I completely stopped thinking about what could happen. I reached college for the next OA, at my desk in the designated classroom, and with just a few minutes to the OA, Sparsh Ma'am from the TPO came and informed me that I have been selected, and I do not need to give the OA. I reconfirmed it with her, as I was not expecting the results to come so randomly. Alas, I took a sigh of relief.

At the end I was selected from the 2 candidates giving the extra interviews, and one was initially selected on the first day itself. So 2 people for the GM role.

A Small Overview of my Placement Process Experience:

So the entire placement process was a complete rollercoaster ride in itself, and there were a lot of ups and downs. About some other companies I applied for, I reached the JPMC interviews but couldn't appear for them due to a family emergency. This taught me that there are some things which are **beyond our control**. I reached the HR round for Work India but was one of the 2 students out of 4 who weren't selected. So you never know what requirements the companies have, and you may get **rejected even at the last minute**.

Other times either I couldn't clear the OA, and for one of the companies I couldn't sit for the OA because the CG criteria for it was 8, and I had a CG of 7.9. (Try to keep your CG above 8)

So yeah, there's a lot going on, and a lot of luck (trust me, a lot !!) involved in the process. But I think overall, if you've worked hard, and if you have the skill sets, you'll end up in one of the good companies regardless. Just remember to not give up, have faith in yourself and keep trying. Everything happens for a reason.

Useful Tips:

- 1) It's very very important to not lose hope or give up. Right till the start of my 3rd year, I was planning to do Non Tech and not even sit for tech companies. But my internship changed my perspective. I started DSA, more dev, and things started falling into place. **So even if you haven't started yet, it's never too late. Just work hard and give it your all.**
- 2) **Luck is a major major factor** in placements. Do not underestimate it, but also do not let it affect you as well.
- 3) Resume building is very crucial. Know the format well, **ONLY INCLUDE WHAT YOU ARE CONFIDENT ABOUT**, learn the concepts if you have lied on your resume.

My Resume -  Aman_Kanojia_Resume.pdf

- 4) Pick a programming language to master. I chose **Python**. **Companies prefer Java** a lot, almost all of them. So maybe go for that or **C++**, and practice Python every now and then.
- 5) Giving **contests** on Leetcode or Codeforces (again, Competitive Programming can help a lot, it's not required though). This will help you learn to code under time constraints.
- 6) Build your **communication skills**, very important for interviews. Maybe help each other by taking each other's interviews. I had been good at it, so I didn't prepare much. But one can rehearse, get some tips from youtube and participate in competitions for it.

It is very important to know how to answer your interviewers be it Tech or HR. Always greet when you enter, wait for their offer to take a seat, greet when leaving. These minor things leave an impact. Know how to build stories around your answers from past experiences, or maybe even lie a little, elaborate on your answers, give some extra information to what you're asked to show how you stand out. These things specifically help in HR rounds a lot.

Prepare a good introduction about yourself. It should include the following points:

- First greet and thank for the opportunity
- Name, degree, college and year. Where you've been born and brought up (cover this in like 2 short sentences max)
- A brief about your skills (like good fundamentals in Full Stack Development or Machine Learning, built scalable projects)
- Mention your internship experience if you have any in 2-3 lines, what you did there and how it was for you
- Give an overview of 1 or 2 of your projects, what they are and what they solve. Unless asked for, don't explain more projects.
- Then cover any extracurricular activities apart from Tech, like I was the Head of Marketing for Oculus. Your experience in it and what you did.

- Move on to any achievements, competitions, hobbies (all of this in one line)
- And lastly, but **most importantly**, briefly explain why you are a good fit for the role by matching with JD and covering your skills.

Any introduction anywhere between 30 seconds to 1.5 minutes is good enough.

- 7) **DSA** is not only going to get you better at Data Structures and Algorithms, but also build your logical thinking and fluency with the language you code in.

Resource - <https://takeuforward.org/strivers-a2z-dsa-course/strivers-a2z-dsa-course-sheet-2/>

This right here is your Bible for DSA, and I'd personally recommend Striver's videos. You can also take a look at NeetCode 150. Striver's SDE sheet is when you're well versed with DSA.

- 8) Prepare for **OOPS**, preferably in Java, and the language you are confident about.

Resource-  OOP 1 | Introduction & Concepts - Classes, Objects, Constructors, Keywords

CheatSheet-

<https://whimsical.com/object-oriented-programming-cheatsheet-by-love-babbar-YbSgLatbWQ4R5paV7EgqFw>

For **Java** - <https://www.tpointtech.com/java-tutorial>

- 9) Prepare for **DBMS** and **SQL** from Love Babbar's videos.

DBMS -  Introduction to DBMS Placements Course 2022

SQL - Leetcode SQL 50 is more than enough <https://leetcode.com/studyplan/top-sql-50/>

- 10) Prepare for **Puzzles** and **Guesstimates** as well.

Puzzles - <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/aptitude/top-100-puzzles-asked-in-interviews/>

Guesstimates - Videos on youtube Cheatsheet - <https://180dcsrc.in/guesstimate-cheat-sheet-2024/>

- 11) You can prepare for **System Design** as well, which I have done. Even if it's not asked directly, it improves your understanding of concepts very well. Although you can easily skip this.
- 12) GFG is great for questions on **Core Concepts** (OS, CCN, Language specific)
- 13) Prepare **Aptitude** questions from **IndiaBix** - <http://indiabix.com/aptitude/questions-and-answers/>
- 14) Have at least 3 projects ready. They shouldn't be too simple, having some impact is always appreciated. Projects on Development or Machine Learning are the most common.
- 15) Actively participate in **Hackathons**, maybe even **Case Study Competitions** (it will give you more confidence)

THANKS FOR READING THIS FAR.

FEEL FREE TO REACH OUT ANY TIME HERE:

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ALL THE VERY BEST !!!